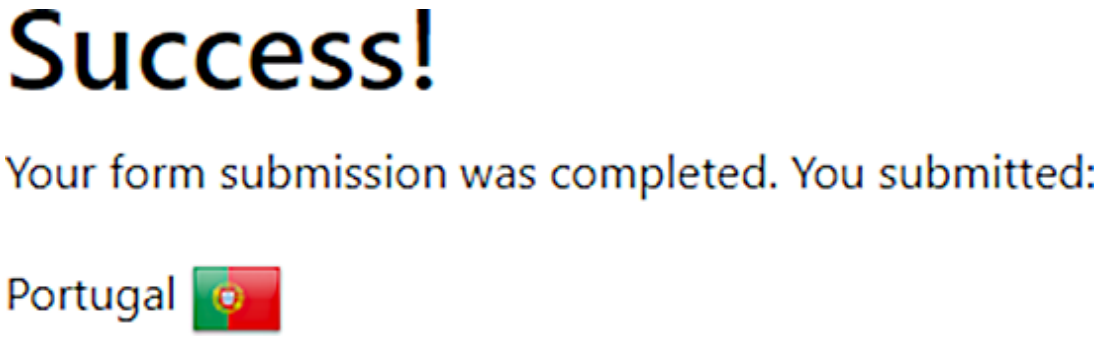


Figure 5.12 Values retained in `TempData` during a redirect

5.3.4 Managing more complex validation with ModelState

Validation attributes work for the vast majority of simple validation needs, but they are relatively limited in that the validation scenarios they handle are binary. A value either passes the test, or it doesn't. Also, they only operate on one value. There will be occasions when your validation scenarios are complex. Perhaps some values will only be required under certain circumstances, for example, or the range that you want to apply could be variable. And that variability could apply from time to time or from one user to another, perhaps.

The most direct way to apply this type of validation is to use C# code in your `OnPost` handler. You write code to validate values, and if validation fails, you add an entry into the `ModelState` object using its `AddModelError` method. Let us say, for instance, you have a validation rule stating that the first letter of the country name and its code must match. The following code shows the `OnPost` method in the country's `CreateModel` adapted to apply this validation test.

Listing 5.30 Adding an error to `ModelState`